

while the other may be the “super spender.” If two savers marry, one may be the extreme tightwad while the other does not mind spending money as long as their retirement accounts have been funded for the month. However, the coupling of a saver with a spender usually results in the most extreme differences in approaches to money out of all the pairings.

This balancing out effect can be a positive influence on couple's lives. If two savers marry, they may miss out on opportunities in their lives since they are averse to spending money. They may never visit a foreign country or go to the opera. Conversely, if two spenders marry, their tendency to splurge may lead them to bankruptcy court.

The following are some common polarizations that couples may adopt in their attitudes about money:

- Saver vs. Spender (Do you prefer to put extra money in the bank or in the cash register?)
- Ostrich vs. Agonizer (Do you pretend nothing is wrong or do you lose sleep over money problems?)
- Gambler vs. Security Guard (Do you prefer high-risk investments or do you put your money in safe government bonds?)
- Plotter vs. Romantic (Do you plan your financial moves in detail or just dream about that house you have always wanted?)
- Joint Accounts vs. Separate (Do you have the philosophy that “what's mine is yours” or “what's mine is mine”?)

Which category do your parents fall into? What about your own relationships? Do you see a pattern emerging? Usually your financial attitudes will remain the same from one relationship to the next but their degree of intensity will vary depending on your partner.

